

About the State

Resume of the News of the Week from All Parts of Oregon

P. M. Brandt has resigned as assistant to dean and director of the University of Missouri college of agriculture and comes to Oregon agricultural college as successor to Professor R. R. Graves, resigned as head of the dairy department. He was first choice of several good men applying to Dean Cordley for the position.

The purchase of 6100 head of lambs for \$55,000 by C. C. Brown of Pocatello, Idaho, was completed last week. The lambs were bought from C. C. Clark of Arlington. They will be shipped to Nebraska, from various points along the O. W. R. & N. road.

Construction of the short-line trail from Oakridge to McKenzie bridge, in the Cascade National forest, designed to reduce the distance 30 miles and the travel time one day, has been suspended because funds available for trails are needed to control forest fires. Work on this trail, which will connect the Willamette and McKenzie watersheds, has been under way since early spring. Trail construction in the Cascade National forest is now at a standstill, except where it is being carried on by fire patrol forces.

Ranchers in the vicinity of Haines have prepared to fight the I. W. W. and the long dry spell. At a well-attended meeting in the Haines city hall they discussed the best ways to protect their crops and grain, both in the field and after it is in the warehouse. It was decided to place a special policeman to patrol the field around the warehouses at night to see that no fires are started accidentally or otherwise. Insurance companies are doing a thriving business in placing policies on crops and hay.

The Northwest Steel company, the Columbia River Shipbuilding and the Albina Engine and Machine works were ordered officially to turn over all vessels under construction to the federal government, which will direct completion of the work and disposal of the ships. In the three yards named vessels are under construction which had been ordered by five foreign nations. More than 30 ships are involved in the order.

The mill of the Appendorff Lumber company, six miles from Sherwood, caught fire last night, supposedly from a brush fire, and was destroyed. The loss was estimated at \$50,000. About 2,000,000 feet of logs were burned. So great was the demand for fire fighters in this district that a large number of women joined with men in fighting brush fires.

The Utah-Idaho Sugar company has purchased the De Barr tract, between Medford and Central Point, consisting of 255 acres, for \$25,000. There are five acres of orchard and the property is bisected by the Southern Pacific tracks. The land contains an available site for a sugar factory, should the growth of the business justify it in the future.

Increased railroad tariff rates from eastern points on glass bottles and jars will meet with an immediate protest from the Northwest Fruit Products company, which operates at Salem and at Olympia and Bellingham.

ham, Wash., according to a letter on file with the State Public Service commission.

La Grande has been assured there will be no coal famine this winter and that the price will come down from its present pinnacle, \$11.50. Families have frantically gathered wood as never before this month, thinking it would be impossible to obtain coal.

The Foundation company, a \$580,000 concern, having general offices in New York city, has filed declaration of intention to do a shipbuilding business on a large scale at Portland and Vancouver, Wash. Ways sufficient to handle a big output are being constructed at both places. Wooden craft for government uses are to be built.

Unless the public service commission sees fit to change its ruling on water rates for the Squaw Creek project, or a reduction is secured on appeal to the supreme court, the settlers say they will farm rather than pay the allegedly exorbitant rates allowed by the commission's recent decree.

Owing to the exigencies of this nation's food supply and the reported small catches of salmon, it is the belief of some Oregon cannerymen and fishermen that the open season in this state should be extended. The Columbia River and Southern Oregon fishermen should be allowed to fish a month longer this year than the law now allows," says Roderick L. Macleay, of Portland and Wedderburn.

Prune packing has commenced in the warehouses at Freewater, Ore. In addition to the Milton union, Lamb Fruit company, Denney & Co., Valley Fruit company, two new firms are in the field, namely, Spegal Bros. & Simmons of Freewater and the Earl Fruit company of California. The prunes are being contracted for at \$45 a ton cash.

George W. France, postmaster at Ten Mile, Douglas county, was indicted Thursday by the federal grand jury under the federal espionage act, on the specific charge of attempting to influence young men not to enlist in the army or navy.

L. O. Goodman, who farms the Hudson Bay ranch 10 miles west of Freewater, has harvested 2200 sacks of wheat, the grain running 60 to 80 bushels to the acre.

A small herd of goats perished in a fire on an Umpqua river ranch, according to word reaching Roseburg. The flames extended over a considerable district, but were reported under control. Two bad fires are burning in Douglas county. One on Steamboat river was said to be blazing in huge treetops and jumping from tree to tree.

Because of the shortage of male labor the Shevlin-Hixon company has followed the example set by the Brooks-Scanlon Lumber company at Bend a few weeks ago, and is now employing girls for the lighter work in the sash and door factory.

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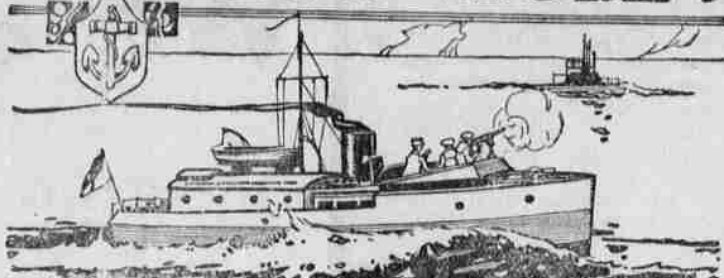
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SEA SLUG STORIES



Thrilling Tales of U Boat Hunting, Told by an American Boy Who Served For Months With the British Patrol and Who Did the Thrilling and Perilous Work That Is Now Being Done by Hundreds of Other American Boys.

No. 1 Chasing U Boats With Sea Slugs

By
A SEA SLUG,
British Service Name For Crews of Submarine Chasers.
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PROLOGUE.

The author of this series of four articles is a young American, who has spent most of his time since the war started with the British patrol fleet, taking an important part in helping to organize that branch of the service known as the Sea Slugs (submarine chasers). He has accumulated a remarkable collection of anecdotes incident to this exciting branch of the service, and many of these were personal adventures in which he took part and which make one of the stirring narratives to come out of the war. He recently returned to the United States to a visit the American navy in organizing the same branch of the service and should be of great value because of his experience abroad. So far as known he is the only American who served with the British patrol prior to the advent of our destroyer flotilla in British waters. Of course some of his experiences, of military value to the enemy, cannot be related. At the request of the service publication of his name is withheld.

WE were all sitting around tables in "The Knut" at Keppel's Head, drinking pink gin and "it," "it" being Angostura bitters. We were a crowd of "sea slugs," as those who man the U boat chasers are commonly and unlovingly called by the rest of the service.

"They can talk all they want to about the science of submarine hunting," said one of the boys, "but there's just one thing that gets submarines—luck. All the schemes the wise heads devise can't come up to one little piece of good fortune."

"Righto," said a subaltern who had just whispered something into the ear of San, the girl who serves drinks at "The Knut." "You take Max Horton, now, the man who torpedoed the Moltke."

"The whole thing is mostly luck. It's luck when we get a sub, and it's luck when a sub gets anything. I had this yarn straight from Max himself."

"He was submerged in one of our subs, an E boat, somewhere under the ocean, and the plumb went out of commission. It isn't very pleasant in a submarine anyway. The smells and the stale air when you are running submerged are enough to make many a man sick who never turned a hair at the roughest sea while he was afloat."

"Well, as I was saying, the plumb went out of commission just as Horton was dressing and had washed up. He hadn't put his trousers on as yet. He ordered the craft to the surface so one of the mechanics could make repairs to the plumbing and meanwhile went on dressing."

Surprised at Seeing Moltke.
"He was standing on one foot while sticking the other through a trousers leg just as the periscope of the submarine stuck out above the surface."

"Suddenly a seaman broke into his cabin and yelled, 'There's a German warship on our starboard quarter, sir!'"

"Max kicked himself free of his trousers quicker than you could wink, and in a matter of seconds he was bent over one of the forward torpedo tubes sighting on the vessel ahead of him. The silhouette book showed she was the battle cruiser Moltke."

"Whiz-z-z! sang the torpedo. Bang! went the Moltke. Max submerged again and finished putting on his trousers. Rather clever, don't you think—standing there with his shirt tails dangling and putting a German battleship?"

"That's a good deal like"—began one of the other boys, but before he could finish the sentence a messenger came in and spoke to the "Brass Hat," who was among us, which is to say he spoke to the senior officer.

"Come on, old chap," said that individual. "We can't wait for the last drink San is bringing. A little job is on our hands."

As we ran down the wharf the men in the chasers started the motors, and by the time we had tumbled pell-mell into the boats they were ready to get away.

Speeding through the Solent, still ignorant of our errand except for the Brass Hat, we passed miles of shipping tied up in the harbor waiting for cargoes or to be unloaded.

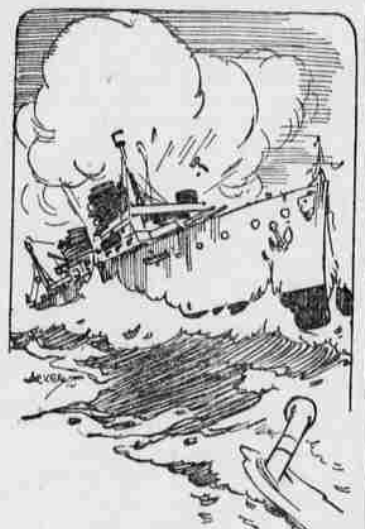
Later on the Brass Hat, whose boat

was leading the line because of his rank, signaled to us that we were after a submarine which a hydroplane had sighted off the Isle of Wight.

The U Boat Chase.

Offshore a short distance was a patrol boat lying very low in the water and flying distress signals. We ran over to her and learned that about an hour before the periscope of a submarine had been stuck up not far from her; then the craft had submerged, appeared again about a mile away and fired four shots, which let in enough water slowly to sink the patrol, which before the war had been nothing but a dirty little trawler.

Finding the crew of the patrol could take care of themselves in their small



"Whiz-z-z! sang the torpedo. Bang! went the Moltke."

boats and learning that the submarine had run over to the westward, where we knew chain net traps to be laid, we circled in that direction.

Our powerful motors thrummed evenly. The water seemed to part ahead of us, and the gunners squinted along the surface.

Suddenly off to the west we made out her periscope. Intense joy thrilled our little crews. She was inshore from us. She was between our circular course and the chain nets—in the trap. The periscope we had seen might be a dummy, for a submarine frequently casts loose a phony periscope to draw fire, but at any rate she must have been between us and the nets if she cut it loose.

Presently, probably after a look around, the periscope suddenly disappeared, and we knew it was a real one with a German U boat on the end of it. The Brass Hat, in his own boat, was, of course, in the lead. That was his prerogative as well as his duty. Like a flock of falcons we were swooping down on the prey.

Abruptly the lead boat comes to a dead stop and lists heavily to starboard. Evidently something is wrong. We see men crawl out over the stern and fish around with boat hooks and poles. Cold as it is one man goes overboard and remains under water so long we could not believe he would come up alive.

We can see the Brass Hat gesticulating as we run in closer. We can't hear what he is saying, but we have a pretty good idea. We've listened to him before when distressed. One of his men signals that the boat has fouled the chain nets. We wouldn't dare cheer, but we are inclined that way. Everybody likes to put it over a Brass Hat, and now there are only five of us to share the glory at the finish. Each of us stands a better chance of being the one to give the submarine its coo.

Circling round in an even smaller radius, we search the water for a periscope, a shadow or the conventional "streak of dirty grease" or "line of bubbles."

Brass Hat Still Stranded.

The Brass Hat is signaling now for us to go over and help him off. Nobody pays any attention to those orders. He wants to run things and get the U boat himself, but we won't give him the chance. Later we will tell him we didn't see his distress signals. Now he tries to direct the procedure from where he is, but we are like a lot of hounds released from restraint. The one idea of our lives is to get that U boat.

All of us have towing torpedoes out. These are bombs on long cables, which are towed astern and sink to a certain specified depth. If the cable fouls anything at all as the boat goes ahead the bomb pulls up to it, and when it bumps it explodes.

We are in line. Suddenly there is a crash and a roar just ahead of us. I am thrown off my feet. Barrels of water splash down into our cockpit and roll off the decks. The bow lifts itself clean for a second. I think that the submarine has blown us up. Perhaps I am dead already.

Continued on Page 8

SOLDIERS ARRESTED

Men in Company with Minor Girls in North End Home

Disregarding their objection to being arrested and confined by civil authorities, two soldiers from Camp Withycombe were arrested in the North End late Saturday night in company with two minor girls. The soldiers and the girls were occupying a private residence and were located upon information of neighbors. The

soldiers were Privates George Manning and Dore Eoodida of Company K, O. N. G., and authorities will withhold the names of the girls. All four were taken to the city jail and confined for the night. Sunday an officer and a small guard was brought from Clackamas and the soldiers were returned to the camp with a promise from the officer that they would be prosecuted for their offense and for remaining away from the camp without a pass. Patrolmen Long and

Then we settle down again, and except for a scared look on the faces of a couple of men and rather nervous, forced jests on the lips of others we are plowing ahead just as before.

Nothing has happened except the towing torpedo of the boat in front of us in the line fouled a submerged spar or a bit of wreckage and exploded right under our bow. "If we had been a few yards closer we would never have been there any more."

As we realized what had happened our tongues were loosened, and if the crew of the boat ahead could have heard what we said about them we would have lost their friendship most assuredly.

Way inshore, after a circling chase of perhaps twenty minutes, the submarine came up. She was in such shallow water that she probably was having trouble in operating submerged. She was gone then.

What followed was very businesslike. It illustrates the attitude the British have come to take toward the submarines because of their flagrant violations of every form of international law and decency. It is the attitude which any country obliged to fight against them will assume. To the British mind submarines must be exterminated just as one would exterminate a nest of poisonous vipers or a nest of hornets. People ask me how many submarines are being captured now. Very few. Many are destroyed, but few captured.

No sooner did the hull of the submarine show itself than we began to hammer her with our three inch guns. She opened fire, but her shots went wild, and in a few seconds she disappeared.

As fast as we could we ran over to where she had gone down. If the principles which obtain on land, in the air or in the navy at large existed in submarine warfare we would have gone over to see if we could rescue any of the wounded, but it was a U boat, and we simply made sure that there was nothing left of the craft.

Some Bubbles, a Greasy Patch—That's All.

About where she went down a quantity of gas and air bubbles was rising, and the dirty patch of oil was once more in evidence. That was a pretty certain sign the career of one U boat was at an end, for the sea must have been pouring into her, and even though all her crew did not drown, once the salt water reached the storage batteries the chlorine would do the work.

But we are taking no chances. We circle round and round the spot and drop depth bombs—deadly machines. These are powerful explosives which are set so they will detonate at a certain depth. We first sounded the bottom and then set our bombs for ten fathoms. Suddenly I hear a cry from the boat behind us. One of the crew reaches out, grabs the collar of a man who has just dropped a depth bomb over the stern and yanks him unceremoniously into the cockpit. At a glance I see what has happened.

The engineer has stalled his motor just as the bomb is let go. It sinks slowly, and there is a slight momentum left in the submarine chaser. We hold our breath and watch in suspense, expecting any second to see our comrades hurled into the air among a mushroom of water and splinters.

There is no way to help them. Suddenly there is a muffled roar, a column of water rises to what seems a hundred feet and falls back, drenching every one who is near it. But our comrades are unhurt. The momentum of their boat has carried them just far enough to save them from being blown



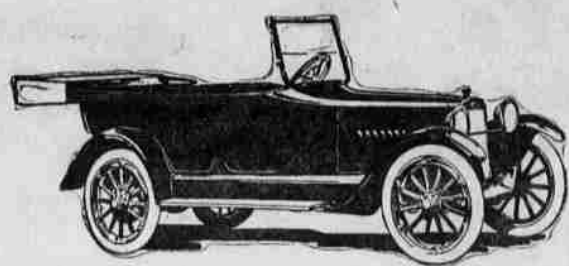
We Began to Hammer Her With Our Three Inch Guns.

Into atoms. That is the second narrow escape for our little squadron in this chase after a single submarine.

The End of the U Boat.

But our work is done. There is no doubt now about the fate of the U boat. It is not necessary for one of the depth bombs actually to come in contact with the submerged craft to destroy it. When under water a submarine's rigidity is multiplied. Its elasticity is next to nothing. An explosion as powerful as that of a depth bomb near it is almost certain to cripple it if not destroy it. It is the same principle as that which kills fish in a pond when dynamite is exploded beneath the surface of the water. The shock is sufficient to kill the men in the U boat, and so we glide along homeward secure in the knowledge that even if our gunfire did not finish the enemy the bombs have done the work. On the surface we notice swarms of dead fish.

We cut the Brass Hat free from the nets and listen to him curse, then return to Keppel's Head and "The Knut," where San had our drinks waiting for us. The subaltern, who had been interrupted in his story when we went out



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DEER SEASON CLOSES

Danger to Soldiers and Forests Prompts Governor in Act

To prevent soldiers from being mistaken for deer, and to reduce the risk of forest fires, Governor Withycombe will issue a proclamation closing the deer season from September 1, next Saturday, for an indefinite period.

"The woods are full of soldiers, wearing olive-drab uniforms, about the same shade as a deer," explained Governor Withycombe, "and a hunter might make a mistake and shoot. Then, again, hunters may cause fires,

and the woods are now as dry as tinder. The proclamation will close the deer season until it is opened by proclamation, and it will not be opened until the first heavy rains, which will make the forests safe from fires. There is another feature in closing the deer season. Some of the forest fires are of incendiary origin and a firebug, caught by a patrolling soldier, might kill the guard and if apprehended later explain that he mistook the soldier for a deer."

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